

Complete guide

19 frameworks with reference notes and printable worksheets

Strategy and growth, positioning, customers and loyalty, content and communications, and impact planning.

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Ansoff Growth Strategy Matrix: reference

INTERACTIVE ANSOFF-MATRIX PROTOTYPE

The Ansoff matrix structures growth choices around two questions: are you working with existing or new products, and existing or new markets? Use it to generate and evaluate strategic options across penetration, market development, product development and diversification.

Risk generally increases as unfamiliarity increases—but the matrix is not a risk score. Assess customer demand, strategic fit, capability, economics, delivery capacity, competition, regulation and ethical implications before committing resources. “New” must be defined for your specific organisation and target market.

Growth strategy map

Select a quadrant to inspect its initiative, target market, evidence and risk boundary.

Options mapped

Known product + known market

Known product + new market

New product + known market

New product + new market

EXISTING PRODUCTS

NEW PRODUCTS

PORTFOLIO COVERAGE

All four options are mapped. The priority is not to pursue all of them: compare evidence, strategic fit, timing, capability and risk.

LEARNING DESIGN

Every option has an evidence-and-test plan. Set success measures, decision thresholds and an explicit learning review before scaling.

RISK MANAGEMENT

Using the Ansoff matrix well

- Define “existing” and “new” explicitly. A new country, channel, customer segment, use case, feature or business model may carry very different levels of novelty and risk.
- Start with the customer problem, not the quadrant. Growth is valuable only if it creates relevant value for a clearly defined audience and can be delivered responsibly.
- Use market penetration beyond promotion: improve retention, onboarding, accessibility, product quality, distribution, pricing clarity and customer success where appropriate.
- Test market development with local or segment-specific research. Do not assume a proposition, message, channel or operating model transfers unchanged.
- For product development and diversification, use staged investment: discovery, prototype, pilot, evaluation and then measured scaling.
- Review second-order effects: cannibalisation, service demand, data protection, supply constraints, emissions, customer harm, staff workload and mission drift.

Guidance by Growth strategy

Market Penetration

Market Penetration risk prompt: Usually the most familiar option, but saturation, rising acquisition cost, customer fatigue and discount dependence can still undermine value.

Market Development

Market Development risk prompt: The product may be proven, but the market context, customer needs, regulation, language, channel economics and trust signals may be unfamiliar.

Product Development

Product Development risk prompt: Customer familiarity does not guarantee demand. Test desirability, feasibility, viability, cannibalisation and the cost to support the new offer.

Diversification

Diversification risk prompt: This combines unfamiliar product and market assumptions. It can create options, but usually requires the strongest governance, capability and financial discipline.

Ansoff Growth Strategy Matrix: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Business, product portfolio or proposition

For example: Product line, service business or strategic initiative

Growth strategy

☐ Market Penetration ☐ Market Development ☐ Product Development ☐ Diversification

Initiative or growth hypothesis

Describe a specific action rather than a broad ambition.

Target market or customer group

Who is the customer, segment, use case, geography, channel or need?

Evidence and test

What evidence supports the option, and what low-risk experiment could validate it?

Key risk, dependency or boundary

Name the most consequential uncertainty, trade-off or ethical boundary.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

BCG Growth-Share Matrix: reference

INTERACTIVE PORTFOLIO-STRATEGY PROTOTYPE

Plot products, brands or business units against market growth and relative market share. The matrix can make portfolio conversations more concrete: which offers may deserve investment, which can fund development, which need a deliberate decision and which may need repositioning, harvesting or exit.

Use the BCG matrix as a prompt, not an automatic strategy. Share and growth are imperfect proxies for cash generation, attractiveness and strategic value. Consider profitability, customer need, capability, risk, competitive dynamics, mission, switching costs and future scenarios—especially in smaller or digital businesses.

Portfolio growth-share map

Select a portfolio bubble to inspect the assumptions, strategic note and possible decision prompts.

Star: invest to sustain leadership

Question Mark: choose to invest or exit

Cash Cow: sustain and fund priorities

Dog: harvest, reposition or divest

MARKET GROWTH RATE

HIGH GROWTH

LOW GROWTH

HIGH GROWTH · HIGH SHARE

Stars

Protect and develop leadership; growing markets can still require substantial investment.

HIGH GROWTH · LOW SHARE

Question Marks

Choose selectively: invest to build a credible position, reposition or exit.

LOW GROWTH · HIGH SHARE

Cash Cows

Maintain health and cash generation while funding other strategic priorities.

LOW GROWTH · LOW SHARE

Dogs

Consider harvesting, redesigning, repositioning, partnering or exiting—based on wider value.

RELATIVE MARKET SHARE: HIGH (LEFT) TO LOW (RIGHT)

Using the growth-share matrix well

- Treat growth and share as directional estimates. Document sources and refresh them regularly.

- Define the market boundary first; a narrow or broad definition can move an item between quadrants.
- Use thresholds that suit your industry rather than defaulting to 10% growth and 1.0x share.
- Look beyond two axes: profitability, capability, customer value, risk and strategic fit all matter.
- Balance the portfolio: Question Marks and Stars need cash that Cash Cows and careful Dogs can help provide.

BCG Growth-Share Matrix: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Product, brand or business unit

For example: Enterprise service, product line or business unit

Strategic note

Capture the context behind the numbers: customer value, competitive advantage, constraints or strategic rationale.

Market growth rate

Use overall market growth, not the individual product's revenue growth.

-10

40

Relative market share

A useful convention is your market share divided by the largest competitor's share; above 1.0 indicates leadership.

0.1

2.5

High-growth threshold

High-share threshold

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Porter's Five Forces: reference

INTERACTIVE STRATEGY-ANALYSIS PROTOTYPE

Assess competitive rivalry, buyer power, supplier power, the threat of new entrants and the threat of substitutes. Use the map to identify where pressure sits, what makes it stronger, and how your organisation could be less exposed.

Use this for industry structure, not a generic competitor list. The model asks how value is distributed among industry actors and what makes a market more or less attractive—not simply which brands look similar today.

Five Forces map

Select a force to inspect its rationale, pressure level and strategic response.

Industry pressure: 3.2 / 5

COMPETITIVE STRUCTURE

Earth-observation and satellite-data communication services f...

Rivalry among existing competitors

STRONG · 4 / 5

STRONGEST PRESSURE

Rivalry is currently the strongest pressure at 4 / 5.

STRATEGIC FOCUS

Focus on rivalry. Differentiate through combined Earth-observation literacy, responsible communication, interactive tools and locally grounded stakeh...

WATCH FOR CHANGE

Supplier power is currently the lowest pressure, but it may change with technology, regulation, concentration or customer behaviour.

Strategy prompts

- ? Define the market narrowly enough that the same buyers, alternatives and competitive conditions apply.
- ? Separate direct competitors from substitutes that solve the same underlying customer problem in another way.
- ? Identify structural drivers—not just individual brands—including switching costs, concentration, entry barriers, differentiation and procurement.
- ? Look beyond current conditions: which forces could become stronger or weaker over the next two to five years?
- ? Convert the diagnosis into choices: where can the organisation differentiate, reduce dependency, raise switching costs or avoid head-to-head rivalry?

Guidance by Force to assess

Rivalry among existing competitors

Threat of new entrants

Bargaining power of buyers

Bargaining power of suppliers

Threat of substitutes

Porter's Five Forces: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Market or industry definition

Keep the definition focused: product/service, customer group and geography where relevant.

Force to assess

- ☐ Rivalry among existing competitors ☐ Threat of new entrants ☐ Bargaining power of buyers
☐ Bargaining power of suppliers ☐ Threat of substitutes

Competitive pressure: 1 weak → 5 very strong

1

5

What makes this force strong or weak?

List the structural drivers: switching costs, concentration, differentiation, capital needs, data access, procurement, regulation, alternatives and so on.

Possible strategic response

How might the organisation reduce exposure, create differentiation or change the terms of competition?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Lean Analytics Stages: reference

INTERACTIVE STARTUP-METRICS PROTOTYPE

Lean Analytics helps teams progress from a problem hypothesis to a scalable business by focusing on one core uncertainty at a time: customer need, retention, organic growth, sustainable revenue and efficient scale. Use each stage to define an experiment, select practical evidence and decide what must be true before moving forward.

Do not treat the stages as a universal, rigid sequence. A product may need to revisit earlier assumptions, and not every business relies on virality. The useful principle is to resolve the most consequential uncertainty before spending heavily on the next growth lever.

Lean Analytics journey

Select a stage to inspect its central question, evidence, current experiment and gate to progress.

Current learning focus

Learning-plan coverage

5 of 5 stages planned

CURRENT EXPERIMENT

DECISION THRESHOLD

NEXT MOVE

Experiment discipline

- ? Start with a decision, not a dashboard: state what uncertainty this metric is meant to reduce.
- ? Use a small, credible experiment before committing large budgets, extensive build effort or irreversible choices.
- ? Pair quantitative signals with qualitative observation—numbers can tell you what happened, but not always why.
- ? Avoid vanity metrics that look impressive but do not change a product, customer or investment decision.
- ? Set a threshold in advance, including what you will do if the evidence is weaker, mixed or stronger than expected.
- ? Respect privacy and consent: collect only data you need, explain its use and avoid manipulative growth tactics.

Guidance by Lean Analytics stage

1. Empathy — problem and customer understanding

Empathy experiment: Conduct semi-structured problem interviews with research-development staff and principal investigators; use a simple interactive prototype to test whether the proposed workflow is understand...

Decision rule: At least 12 of 15 relevant interviewees describe a recurring problem and agree to test a prototype

If supported: Build a narrow MVP focused on stakeholder mapping, pathway design and collaborative export, then test whether early users return to complete a second planning task.

2. Stickiness — engagement and retention

Stickiness experiment: Run a six-week pilot with a small cohort; track activation, repeated use, completed maps, collaboration invitations and qualitative reasons for return or drop-off.

Decision rule: At least 40% of activated pilot users return in week 4 and complete a second meaningful planning action

If supported: Refine onboarding and the core planning workflow around the repeated value moment before investing materially in broader acquisition.

3. Virality — repeatable growth loops

Virality experiment: Test contextual collaboration prompts, shareable read-only outputs and team templates with pilot users; compare invitation behaviour and invited-user activation.

Decision rule: At least 25% of activated workspaces invite a collaborator, and at least half of invited collaborators activate

If supported: Develop the strongest collaboration loop and test it with a narrow acquisition channel before increasing promotion spend.

4. Revenue — monetisation and unit economics

Revenue experiment: Offer a paid team plan with clear value tiers after the pilot; conduct structured pricing conversations and track conversion, objections and use by role.

Decision rule: At least 30% of eligible pilot organisations convert to a paid plan at a price that supports a viable gross margin

If supported: Confirm pricing, package boundaries and sales motion, then test acquisition-payback assumptions with a small repeatable pipeline.

5. Scale — efficient repeatable growth

Scale experiment: Expand through a limited set of university partnerships and track performance by institution, segment, channel, onboarding model and support requirement.

Decision rule: New cohorts retain at comparable levels, payback remains within the agreed period and support demand stays within planned capacity

If supported: Scale only the channels, segments and operational systems that preserve customer value and unit economics.

Lean Analytics Stages: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Venture, product or experiment

For example: A new SaaS product, marketplace or service

Lean Analytics stage

- ☐ 1. Empathy — problem and customer understanding ☐ 2. Stickiness — engagement and retention
- ☐ 3. Virality — repeatable growth loops ☐ 4. Revenue — monetisation and unit economics
- ☐ 5. Scale — efficient repeatable growth

Current hypothesis or question

What do you believe, and what uncertainty are you trying to reduce?

One metric that matters

For example: Week-4 retention or trial-to-paid conversion

Decision threshold

What result would justify progress, iteration or stopping?

Experiment or evidence-gathering activity

Describe the smallest credible test you will run.

Next action if the threshold is met

State the next decision or experiment—not a vague ambition.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

STP Marketing Model: reference

INTERACTIVE AUDIENCE-STRATEGY PROTOTYPE

Segment the wider audience into meaningful groups, choose the people you can serve best, then position your offer around a specific need, benefit and reason to believe. STP helps replace one-size-fits-all marketing with focused, useful communication.

Segments are hypotheses, not stereotypes. Build them from relevant needs, contexts and behaviours—not vague labels alone. Test whether a group is real, reachable, meaningful and appropriate for your offer before investing in a campaign.

STP strategy flow

Move from a broad market to carefully defined segments, selected targets and a clear positioning statement.

Target segments selected

Segment by needs and context

Target for fit and opportunity

Position with value and proof

Segmentation

Identify meaningful groups with distinct needs, contexts or behaviours.

Targeting

Prioritise segments based on attractiveness and your ability to serve them well.

Positioning

State how the chosen audience should understand your offer compared with alternatives.

POSITION FOR PUBLIC-SECTOR CLIMATE AND PLACE T...

Distinct value proposition

“For public-sector climate and place teams, this service is an evidence-to-engagement partner that turns complex Earth-observation insight into credible, accessible and decision-ready communication because it combines domain literacy, interactive design and locally grounded facilitation.”

REASON TO BELIEVE

POSITION FOR UNIVERSITY RESEARCH AND IMPACT TE...

“For university research and impact teams, this service is a practical strategy-and-design partner for turning environmental research into understandable, participatory and evidentially responsible impact activity.”

Experience with research impact frameworks, collaborative mapping tools and accessible evidence communication.

AUDIENCE FOCUS

3 segments mapped. 2 have been assessed for strategic priority.

MESSAGE RELEVANCE

2 positioning statements drafted. Ensure each highlights a relevant benefit and a credible reason to believe.

EVIDENCE CHECK

Validate segment size, needs, accessibility and response using ethically collected customer research, service data, interviews, observation and campaign learning.

STP review prompts

- ? Does each segment represent a meaningful shared need, context or behaviour—not merely a convenient demographic label?
- ? Is there evidence that the segment is substantial enough, reachable through appropriate channels and likely to value the offer?
- ? Can you serve the chosen target well given your capability, credibility, delivery model, budget and access to channels?
- ? Does the positioning explain why this audience should choose the offer over realistic alternatives, including doing nothing?
- ? Does every claim have a reason to believe, such as a proof point, case study, credible capability or independently verifiable evidence?
- ? Could any segmentation or targeting choice unfairly exclude, stereotype or disadvantage people? If so, redesign it.

Guidance by STP stage

Segmentation — add an audience group

Targeting — evaluate a segment

Positioning — define the message

STP Marketing Model: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Offer, product or service

For example: A sustainable product range, software tool or professional service

STP stage

☐ Segmentation — add an audience group ☐ Targeting — evaluate a segment ☐ Positioning — define the message

Segment name

For example: Sustainability-focused early-career professionals

Shared need, context or behaviour

Describe what makes this group meaningfully distinct and relevant.

Audience insight

What job are they trying to do, barrier do they face or outcome do they value?

Segment to evaluate

☐ Public-sector climate and place teams ☐ University research and impact teams ☐ Mission-led climate organisations

Attractiveness

☐ 1 — Very low ☐ 2 — Low ☐ 3 — Moderate ☐ 4 — High ☐ 5 — Very high

Ability to serve

☐ 1 — Very low ☐ 2 — Low ☐ 3 — Moderate ☐ 4 — High ☐ 5 — Very high

Targeting rationale

Why is this segment valuable, reachable, appropriate and a good fit for your capability?

Target segment

☐ Public-sector climate and place teams ☐ University research and impact teams ☐ Mission-led climate organisations

Positioning statement

For [target], [offer] is the [category] that [key benefit] because [reason to believe].

Reason to believe

What proof, capability, methodology, experience or evidence makes the position credible?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Brand Positioning Map: reference

INTERACTIVE PERCEPTUAL-MAPPING PROTOTYPE

Map how customers perceive your brand and the alternatives they genuinely consider. Use two attributes that matter to purchase decisions—such as affordability and specialist expertise, or simplicity and capability—to reveal crowded positions, meaningful differentiation and potential opportunities to investigate.

An empty space is a research question, not automatically an opportunity. A blank area can signal unmet demand, but it can also reflect a trade-off customers do not value, a proposition that is difficult to deliver or missing competitors. Ground map positions in customer evidence and test any positioning hypothesis before investing.

Brand perception map

Select a point to inspect its evidence note and compare its perceived position with the wider competitive set.

Alternatives plotted

Your brand

Competitor

Substitute / adjacent option

Dashed border = own brand

LOWER PERCEIVED VALUE → HIGHER PERCEIVED VALUE

HIGHER PERCEIVED VALUE

LOWER PERCEIVED VALUE

LESS SPECIALISED

MORE SPECIALISED

CUSTOMER PERCEPTION

COMPETITIVE DENSITY

3 close perceived pairings detected. Proximity can indicate that customers see brands as similar on these attributes; test actual consideration and substitution behaviour.

POSITIONING OPPORTUNITY

Your brand currently sits at 72/100 horizontally and 74/100 vertically. Use this as a hypothesis: identify a meaningful target position, then test whether it is desirable, credible and deliverable.

EVIDENCE QUALITY

Every plotted alternative has an evidence note. Next, record source, audience segment, sample and date so the map remains interpretable over time.

How to use a positioning map

- Choose axes that genuinely influence purchase or choice in the category; common axes such as price and quality are only useful if customers use them.
- Include the full consideration set: direct rivals, emerging competitors, substitutes, internal alternatives and familiar workarounds.

- Ask customers—not only internal teams—to rate or discuss the brands. Surveys, interviews, review analysis, social listening and website user testing can complement one another.
- Keep segments separate when perception differs meaningfully by role, need, geography, experience level or buying context.
- Treat distance as a perception signal, not exact competitive truth. A two-axis map simplifies a much richer set of associations and trade-offs.
- Compare intended position with actual customer perception, then test whether a potential new position is valuable, credible, distinctive and operationally sustainable.

Guidance by Brand type

Your brand

Competitor

Substitute or adjacent alternative

Brand Positioning Map: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Brand, competitor or substitute

For example: Your brand, direct competitor or alternative solution

Evidence or perception note

Summarise the research evidence, assumptions or customer language behind this position.

Brand type

☐ Your brand ☐ Competitor ☐ Substitute or adjacent alternative

Horizontal axis: lower end

Horizontal axis: higher end

Vertical axis: lower end

Vertical axis: higher end

Horizontal perception score

0

100

Vertical perception score

0

100

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

7Ps Marketing Mix Canvas: reference

INTERACTIVE MARKETING-PLANNING PROTOTYPE

Use the 7Ps to plan the product or service, price, place, promotion, people, process and physical evidence that shape a customer's experience. It is a structured way to ensure marketing promises align with how the offer is actually delivered.

The seven Ps are interdependent. A persuasive campaign cannot compensate for an unclear offer, a difficult buying process or weak evidence of credibility. Review the mix together whenever customer needs, market conditions or the service design changes.

Your 7Ps marketing mix

Select a circle to inspect the decision, intended effect and evidence for that part of the customer experience.

Elements planned

Offer

Value exchange

Access

Communication

Experience delivery

Trust cues

CUSTOMER VALUE

Every part of the mix should reinforce the value you promise and the experience customers receive.

MIX COMPLETENESS

All seven elements are planned. Check that they reinforce one clear value proposition and customer experience.

TRUST AND DELIVERY

People, process and physical evidence are all defined. Review whether your internal delivery reality matches the message you communicate.

REVIEW TRIGGER

Review before major change. Revisit the mix when you launch, change a price or channel, receive customer feedback, enter a new segment or redesign the service journey.

Marketing-mix review prompts

- ? Is the offer solving a real, specific customer problem—and is the benefit clearer than the feature list?
- ? Does the price communicate value while covering the cost and complexity of delivering a good experience?
- ? Can your priority audience easily find, access, buy and use the offer through the channels you have chosen?
- ? Does promotion describe the same promise that customers encounter in the product, process and people?
- ? What tangible proof reduces risk for someone choosing an unfamiliar or intangible service?
- ? Which assumptions require customer research, usability testing, price testing or campaign measurement rather than internal opinion?

Guidance by Marketing-mix element

Product

Price

Place

Promotion

People

Process

Physical Evidence

7Ps Marketing Mix Canvas: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Offer, service or campaign

For example: A new software platform, consultancy offer or course

Marketing-mix element

☐ Product ☐ Price ☐ Place ☐ Promotion ☐ People ☐ Process ☐ Physical Evidence

Decision, tactic or proposition

Describe what you will do. Keep it specific and customer-focused.

Intended customer effect

What should become easier, clearer, safer, more valuable or more desirable for the customer?

Measure, signal or evidence

How will you know this part of the mix is working?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Customer Lifetime Value Calculator: reference

INTERACTIVE MARKETING-MODEL PROTOTYPE

Customer Lifetime Value estimates the present value of future contribution from a customer relationship. Use it to examine whether acquisition, onboarding and retention investments can be justified over time—not simply by the first transaction.

CLV is an estimate, not a promise or a licence to overspend. Base assumptions on cohorts and representative data, separate revenue from contribution margin, include service and retention costs where material, and update forecasts when retention, pricing, market conditions or customer behaviour changes.

Lifetime-value projection

Present-value forecast for Professional subscription customers.

£539

Net CLV after CAC

PRESENT-VALUE CLV

£849

Projected contribution after service cost and discounting, before acquisition cost.

Present-value CLV less the stated acquisition cost.

CLV : CAC RATIO

2.7 : 1

The relationship covers CAC in this forecast, but assess cash payback, risk and operating costs.

CAC PAYBACK

1 years

Estimated point at which discounted cumulative contribution covers CAC.

Expected contribution by year

Each year reflects remaining customers after retention, expected annual contribution after service cost and the present-value discount factor.

EXPECTED ACTIVE CUSTOMERS

CONTRIBUTION AFTER SERVICE COST

DISCOUNT FACTOR

PRESENT VALUE

CUMULATIVE PV

Year 1

£600.00

£363.00

£324.11

Year 2

£450.00

£272.25

£217.04

£541.14

Year 3

£337.50

£204.19

£145.34

£686.48

Year 4

£253.13

£153.14

£97.32

£783.80

Year 5

£189.84

£114.86

£65.17

£848.98

£324

£217

£145

REVENUE BASIS

£600 expected annual revenue per initially acquired customer, translating to £408 gross contribution before annual service costs and £363 after them.

RETENTION SENSITIVITY

75% annual retention implies 25% annual churn. By year 5, the model expects roughly 32% of the original cohort to remain active.

ACQUISITION DECISION

CAC is repaid at approximately 1 years. Use this as a scenario estimate, then test by acquisition channel and customer cohort.

Use CLV responsibly

- Use cohort-level data. Customers acquired through different channels, plans, geographies or time periods can have very different retention, margin and service costs.
- Calculate contribution, not revenue alone. Include cost of goods or delivery, payment fees, discounts, refunds, support and retention expenditure where material.

- Distinguish observed history from forecasts. Historical CLV describes past cohorts; predictive CLV adds assumptions about future behaviour and should show uncertainty.
- Compare CLV with CAC alongside payback period, not with a universal ratio target. Working capital, gross margin, growth rate and risk tolerance differ by business.
- Do not use CLV estimates to justify manipulative retention, discriminatory pricing or excessive data collection. Design retention around genuine customer value and informed choice.
- Reforecast when pricing, product mix, retention, attribution, service costs or macro conditions change, and document the data source and calculation definition.

Customer Lifetime Value Calculator: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Customer segment or cohort

For example: New customers acquired through paid search

Average order / period revenue

Enter average revenue per transaction or billing period.

Purchases / periods per year

For subscriptions, use billing periods per year.

Gross contribution margin (%)

Use a contribution-oriented margin where possible.

Annual retention rate (%)

Retention is 100% minus annual churn rate.

Customer acquisition cost (CAC)

Include attributable media, sales and onboarding costs.

Annual service / retention cost

Include support, success and retention costs where material.

Annual discount rate (%)

Discounts future contribution to today's value.

Projection horizon (years)

A longer horizon increases forecast uncertainty.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Customer Loyalty Ladder: reference

INTERACTIVE LOYALTY-MODEL PROTOTYPE

A loyalty ladder helps teams plan the customer relationship from initial interest through first purchase, repeat use, support and voluntary advocacy. Use it to identify friction, create genuinely helpful engagement and improve lifetime value through sustained customer value—not pressure or manipulation.

Loyalty is earned, not engineered through dark patterns. Customers do not move in a straight line, and not every satisfied customer wants to advocate publicly. Make communications relevant, consent-based and easy to control; treat re-engagement as an invitation to restore value rather than a reason to create urgency, guilt or friction around leaving.

Customer loyalty journey

Select a rung to inspect the intended customer outcome, activity, measure and experience boundary.

Potential relationship

First value exchange

Repeat relationship

Voluntary support

Voluntary advocacy

Loyalty is not linear. Customers can reduce usage, pause or lapse after any stage. Use insight to remove friction and invite re-engagement where appropriate; respect choices to disengage and do not equate silence with consent.

RACE customer lifecycle connection

RACE connects the loyalty ladder to a broader marketing lifecycle: build awareness, prompt useful interaction, enable conversion and sustain customer value through engagement.

Build relevant awareness and make the offer discoverable for potential prospects.

Enable meaningful interactions such as content use, enquiries, trials or product exploration.

Make a first purchase, commitment or next step clear, accessible and proportionate.

Support successful use, retention, repeat value and voluntary advocacy over time.

LIFECYCLE COVERAGE

All five stages are mapped. Focus on the moments with the greatest customer friction or opportunity rather than adding activity everywhere.

CUSTOMER VALUE

3 of 3 relationship stages are planned. Strengthen loyalty by improving product and service value, reliability, support, transparency and customer control—not just communication frequency.

RE-ENGAGEMENT

Using a loyalty ladder well

- Define stages by observable customer behaviour and relationship needs, not only by database labels or campaign status.

- Measure success with customer-centred indicators such as task success, customer effort, renewal, retention, repeat value, complaint resolution and voluntary recommendation.
- Connect messaging to meaningful value. For example, a reminder is useful only when it helps someone achieve an outcome they genuinely want.
- Expect movement in both directions. Analyse lapse and churn with care, then address service failures, changing needs, affordability, relevance or timing rather than defaulting to more pressure.
- Use RACE to connect loyalty activity with the full lifecycle: Reach creates awareness, Act enables interaction, Convert supports a fair first commitment and Engage develops the relationship.
- Respect consent and privacy. Keep marketing preferences accessible, avoid manipulative urgency and ensure reviews, referrals and testimonials are voluntary and transparently disclosed.

Guidance by Loyalty stage

Prospect

Prospect prompt: A person or organisation with a relevant need who is considering options, but has not yet made a purchase or commitment.

Customer

Customer prompt: A first-time buyer or subscriber assessing whether the actual experience delivers the value they expected.

Client

Client prompt: A repeat customer with an established relationship, familiarity and a reason to continue choosing the organisation.

Supporter

Supporter prompt: A loyal, engaged customer who may participate, provide feedback or support the brand, without being expected to promote it publicly.

Advocate

Advocate prompt: A customer who voluntarily recommends, refers, reviews or otherwise speaks positively about the brand based on authentic experience.

Customer Loyalty Ladder: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Brand, product or service

For example: Service, product line or organisation

Loyalty stage

☐ Prospect ☐ Customer ☐ Client ☐ Supporter ☐ Advocate

Customer outcome

What should become easier, clearer, safer or more valuable for the customer?

Helpful experience or activity

Describe the customer experience, service improvement or communication.

Meaningful measure

For example: Task success, retention, repeat purchase or referral

RACE lifecycle link

☐ Reach ☐ Act ☐ Convert ☐ Engage

Ethical or customer-experience boundary

What should your organisation avoid, and what customer control should be protected?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Customer Lifecycle & Loyalty Ladder: reference

EXPANDED LIFECYCLE MARKETING PLANNER

Customer lifecycle marketing coordinates relevant communications, service and customer experiences from discovery through repeat value and voluntary advocacy. This planner combines the loyalty ladder with the RACE lifecycle—Reach, Act, Convert and Engage—to reveal gaps across the journey rather than treating marketing as a series of isolated campaigns.

Personalisation should be useful, proportionate and controllable. Use customer information to reduce friction and increase relevance—not to exploit vulnerability, create false urgency, conceal choices or make disengagement difficult. Customers may pause, lapse and return; meaningful re-engagement starts by restoring value and trust.

Lifecycle relationship map

Explore lifecycle coverage from initial awareness through ongoing engagement, retention and voluntary advocacy.

Core moments planned

RACE lifecycle flow

Click a stage to inspect its strategy and activities.

Loyalty ladder

Relationship depth grows through value, trust and choice.

Pause, friction or lapse

Customers may become inactive because needs change, value is unclear, service fails, affordability changes or the journey becomes difficult.

Restore value and trust

Use service recovery, relevant support, accessible preference controls and an optional win-back message when there is a real reason to reconnect.

Paid, owned and earned touchpoints

Review how channel types support the lifecycle. Coverage matters, but each activity should have a clear role, customer benefit and measurement approach.

CHANNEL TYPE

Paid media

Search and paid social

Build relevant awareness

Retargeting and lead ads

Prompt useful next steps

Conversion support

Use carefully and transparently

Selective re-engagement

Avoid intrusive repetition

Owned media

SEO and useful content

Make information discoverable

Mapped activity

Offer accessible use-case guidance, a short self-assessment a...

Provide transparent proposal materials, stakeholder-ready res...

Use opt-in onboarding, customer success reviews, role-based l...

Earned media

Publish useful thought leadership, practical examples and par...

Reviews and peer proof

Support informed evaluation

Trusted recommendations

Reduce uncertainty honestly

Invite customers into optional feedback sessions, learning ex...

Always-on lifecycle gap analysis

Use this visual as a workshop prompt: compare the activities that could support each stage with the activities currently in place, then prioritise the gaps that matter most to customers and commercial goals.

Reach

One activity mapped — consider whether a second route or service improvement is needed.

Convert

Engage

3 activities mapped — review quality, overlap and customer relevance.

LIFECYCLE FOCUS

6 lifecycle activities are mapped. Each RACE stage has at least one activity; now assess customer relevance and operational quality.

CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP

3 activities focus on Engage. Retention and loyalty grow from sustained value, support, trust and customer control—not from message frequency alone.

NEXT PLANNING MOVE

4 activities marked high priority. Choose a small number of improvements, define a customer-centred success measure and review results before scaling.

Lifecycle marketing principles

- Plan for the complete relationship. Reach and conversion matter, but post-purchase adoption, service quality, retention, lapse and re-engagement are part of the same customer system.
- Use always-on activity where customers need it: search visibility, useful content, preference-led email, accessible journeys, customer support and service recovery often work best as ongoing capabilities.

- Coordinate paid, owned and earned channels. Their roles differ, but the customer should encounter consistent information, expectations and controls across them.
- Personalise only when it creates a clear customer benefit. Explain data use, minimise collection, respect consent and make preference changes or unsubscribing straightforward.
- Segment responsibly. B2B buying groups, B2C households and individuals have different motivations and accessibility needs; avoid treating a CRM label as a complete picture of a person.
- Measure outcomes as well as volume: customer effort, task success, retained value, repeat purchase, support resolution, accessibility, satisfaction and voluntary advocacy can be more meaningful than opens or clicks.
- Treat advocates as independent customers, not a free media channel. Referrals, reviews and stories should be voluntary, truthful and transparently disclosed where incentives exist.

Guidance by Loyalty stage

Prospect

Customer

Client

Supporter

Advocate

Customer Lifecycle & Loyalty Ladder: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Brand, product or service

For example: Product, service or organisation

Lifecycle context

☐ B2B / complex consideration ☐ B2C / ecommerce and repeat purchase

Loyalty stage

☐ Prospect ☐ Customer ☐ Client ☐ Supporter ☐ Advocate

RACE stage

☐ Reach ☐ Act ☐ Convert ☐ Engage

Primary channel type

☐ Owned media / direct experience ☐ Paid media / retargeting ☐ Earned media / community / referrals

Customer outcome**Always-on activity or experience****Customer-centred measure**

Priority

☐ High priority ☐ Medium priority ☐ Low priority

Customer-experience and ethical boundary

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

The Hook Model: reference

INTERACTIVE PRODUCT-BEHAVIOUR PROTOTYPE

Map the four parts of a repeat-use loop: what prompts a user, the easiest useful action, the value they receive and the contribution that makes the product more valuable next time. Use the model to reduce friction and support beneficial habits—not to exploit attention, anxiety or vulnerability.

Habit-forming is not automatically user-centred. Keep the user's long-term interest as the design constraint. Avoid dark patterns, deceptive urgency, excessive notifications, unwanted data extraction and reward systems that encourage harmful or compulsive use.

Your ethical Hook Model

Select a stage to inspect its design choice, user benefit, evidence and safety guardrail.

GUARDRAILS MAPPED

User wellbeing check

Prompt

Low-friction behaviour

Meaningful payoff

Future value

REPEAT VALUE LOOP

Each stage should help a user achieve a worthwhile outcome with informed, controllable participation.

LOOP COMPLETENESS

All four stages are mapped. Check that every stage delivers a legitimate user benefit and does not depend on harmful pressure.

VALUE TEST

Ask a value question: would a well-informed user say this loop helps them accomplish something they genuinely want, in a way they would choose again?

CONTROL TEST

All stages include evidence or guardrails. Validate these safeguards through accessibility review, user research and product analytics—not assumptions.

Ethical design checks

- Does the product solve a real, user-defined problem rather than create anxiety or dependence to generate engagement?
- Can people control prompts, reminders, personalisation, notifications and recommendations without penalty?
- Is the desired action understandable, reversible where possible and free from deceptive defaults or hidden costs?
- Does the reward provide genuine value without gambling-like uncertainty, fear of missing out or harmful social comparison?
- Is every investment voluntary, proportionate and transparent—and can users export or delete their data easily?

- Would you be comfortable explaining the loop, its data use and its likely effects to users, regulators and an independent ethics reviewer?

Guidance by Hook stage

Trigger

Action

Variable Reward

Investment

The Hook Model: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Product, service or experience

For example: A learning app, SaaS product or subscription service

Hook stage

☐ Trigger ☐ Action ☐ Variable Reward ☐ Investment

Design decision

Describe the user experience, not merely the feature.

User benefit

What legitimate problem does this solve or outcome does it support?

Evidence and ethical guardrail

How will you know it works, and what limit protects the user?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

AIDA Marketing Communications Model: reference

INTERACTIVE MARCOMMS PLANNING PROTOTYPE

AIDA helps you structure campaign communications around four practical goals: become known, earn attention, make the proposition meaningful and help people take the next suitable step. Add Retention when ongoing customer value, trust, loyalty or advocacy matters after the initial conversion.

AIDA is a communication lens, not a literal customer journey. People compare alternatives, consult peers, revisit information and enter at different stages. Pair this canvas with customer research, channel data and accessible, truthful communications rather than assuming a single linear funnel.

AIDA communications map

Select a stage to see the planned message, touchpoint, next action and measurement approach.

Reach and recognition

Understanding and research

Relevance and preference

Friction-free next step

Long-term value

JOURNEY COVERAGE

All five stages are mapped. Validate the actual journey with research: people may enter, pause, compare and return at different points.

MESSAGE DISCIPLINE

Real-world AIDA tips

- Start with audience research: define the decision, context, barriers and trusted information sources before choosing channels or creative.
- Make every promise specific and supportable. Use evidence, representative examples and transparent limitations rather than generic superlatives.
- Match the CTA to the level of commitment: reading, saving, subscribing, booking, trialling and buying are different asks.
- Design for accessibility across copy, contrast, captions, keyboard navigation, forms, language and device conditions.
- Treat social proof responsibly: use real, consented testimonials and do not fabricate popularity, countdowns, availability or reviews.
- Use the funnel as a diagnostic aid, then check non-linear behaviour through customer interviews, journey data and support feedback.

Guidance by AIDA stage

Awareness / Attention

Awareness / Attention prompt: How will the right audience first notice and recognise the offer or issue in a credible, relevant setting?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Relevant reach, awareness, qualified traffic, recall, message recognition and brand search.

Interest

Interest prompt: What information will help people understand the problem, benefits, alternatives and relevance to their situation?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Engaged visits, content completion, useful questions, repeat visits, event registrations and qualified enquiries.

Desire

Desire prompt: What proof, experience or personal relevance helps people move from “this seems useful” to “this may be right for me”?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Demo requests, saved configurations, comparison engagement, case-study use, lead quality and stated preference.

Action

Action prompt: What is the appropriate next step, and how can it be easy, informed, accessible and proportional to the person's readiness?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Completed intended actions, conversion quality, abandonment reasons, accessibility success and consent quality.

Retention (optional AIDAR extension)

Retention prompt: How will the relationship continue to create real value after the initial action, while giving customers meaningful choice and control?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Repeat use, renewal, satisfaction, support outcomes, referrals, retention by cohort and customer lifetime value.

AIDA Marketing Communications Model: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Campaign, proposition or product

For example: Product launch, new service or public information campaign

AIDA stage

☐ Awareness / Attention ☐ Interest ☐ Desire ☐ Action ☐ Retention (optional AIDAR extension)

Audience need or task

What does the audience need to understand, feel confident about or accomplish?

Core message or proof point

State the message clearly and support it with credible evidence.

Channel or touchpoint

For example: Search, PR, email, website, webinar or sales conversation

Appropriate next action

For example: Learn more, download, enquire, book, trial or buy

Measure and ethical boundary

How will you assess usefulness while respecting consent, privacy and accessibility?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

STEPPS Content Framework: reference

INTERACTIVE SHAREABILITY-PLANNING PROTOTYPE

STEPPS helps you design content, products and campaigns that people may find useful, meaningful, visible and worth talking about. Map each principle around a clear audience need, then test the result with real people rather than assuming attention equals value.

Sharing should be voluntary and informed. Do not use misinformation, manufactured outrage, hidden incentives, deceptive scarcity or personal-data exploitation to create reach. A strong campaign earns attention by being relevant, truthful, accessible and genuinely useful.

Your STEPPS canvas

Select an element to inspect its content choice, audience benefit, evidence and ethical constraint.

Elements mapped

Identity and status

Everyday recall

Meaningful feeling

Visible behaviour

Useful help

Memorable narrative

CAMPAIGN COVERAGE

All six elements are mapped. Prioritise clarity and usefulness over trying to force every mechanism into every content item.

AUDIENCE VALUE

Ask before publishing: does this help the intended audience understand, decide, connect or act in a way they would consider worthwhile?

TESTING DISCIPLINE

Every element has an evidence or ethics note. Test comprehension, trust, accessibility, relevance and practical use with representative audiences.

Shareability with integrity

- Is the core claim accurate, sourced where appropriate and clear about uncertainty, limitations and relevance?
- Would a reasonable audience member understand why they are seeing the content and whether it includes a commercial or sponsored message?
- Does the content give people a real choice to share, participate, subscribe or disengage without pressure or penalty?
- Are stories developed with consent, fair representation and context—particularly when they involve communities, vulnerable people or lived experience?
- Is the content accessible across language, reading level, captions, transcripts, colour contrast, image description and format choices where relevant?
- Will success be assessed through meaningful outcomes—such as comprehension, useful action, trust or community benefit—not only reach and engagement?

Guidance by STEPPS element

Social Currency

Triggers

Emotion

Public

Practical Value

Stories

STEPPS Content Framework: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Campaign, content or idea

For example: Product launch, social campaign, video series or public-information resource

STEPPS element

☐ Social Currency ☐ Triggers ☐ Emotion ☐ Public ☐ Practical Value ☐ Stories

Creative or content choice

Describe the specific content, design or message choice.

Audience benefit

Why would the audience find this useful, meaningful or worth sharing?

Evidence, test or ethical boundary

How will you test the idea, and what guardrail prevents misleading or manipulative communication?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Science-to-Story Translator: reference

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION PROTOTYPE

Turn technical source material into audience-aware communication drafts without losing the facts, caveats or limits that make the work trustworthy. Use the output as a structured first draft, then complete expert and editorial review before publishing.

Human review is required. This tool does not verify science, assess evidence quality, identify missing context, or approve claims. It only structures the facts, caveats and links that you provide into communication-ready draft material.

Communication draft pack

REVIEW REQUIRED

Before publishing

Brief summary

Build awareness

Clear and calm

READING LEVEL

General public

One-line value proposition

Plain-English summary

Three messaging pillars

- What the work looks at: The study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.
- What needs care: Lower tree canopy and more impervious surfaces are associated with higher daytime surface temperatures. However, the study measures surface temperature, not indoor temperature.

LinkedIn draft

Webpage introduction

Email draft

SUBJECT LINES

- Urban heat and neighbourhood design: what the evidence can tell us
- New project update: The study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature...
- Learn more about the work: Urban heat and neighbourhood design

SHORT EMAIL COPY

What this does not prove

Interpret with care

This material does not prove that the study measures surface temperature, not indoor temperature, it does not measure individual exposure, health outcomes or future climate impacts, and further local validation and community input are needed before prioritising interventions. It should not be presented as a complete account of the evidence, a causal conclusion, individual advice, or a substitute for the full methodology and qualified review.

Human-review checklist

- ! Confirm every factual statement against the approved source material and latest project information.
- ! Check that required caveats remain visible, intelligible and proportionate for the chosen audience.
- ! Ask an appropriate scientific or technical reviewer to approve terminology, interpretation and causal language.
- ! Check links, data access, permissions, image rights, names, affiliations and contact details.
- ! Confirm the call to action is ethical, accessible and appropriate to the audience and research context.
- ! Read the final version aloud for clear, measured language at a general public reading level.

Review the source, all retained facts, caveats, figures, terminology, audience implications, links, permissions and calls to action. Do not publish the draft as verified scientific advice, policy guidance or evidence of causation unless a qualified reviewer has confirmed it.

Guidance by Intended audience

Public

Draft language for public audiences, written in a clear and calm tone and requiring expert review.

Urban heat and neighbourhood design offers why this matters in everyday places and decisions, using verified project information to help people understand what the work can—and cannot—say.

New work is helping build a clearer picture of urban heat and neighbourhood design. This project examines how land cover, building density and tree canopy influence summer surface temperatures across neighbourhoods in Leicester. The key point is that the study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.

Policy or public sector

Draft language for policy or public sector audiences, written in a clear and calm tone and requiring expert review.

Policy or public sector

Urban heat and neighbourhood design offers what the evidence can inform, alongside its limits, using verified project information to help people understand what the work can—and cannot—say.

New analysis provides evidence that may help inform urban heat and neighbourhood design. This project examines how land cover, building density and tree canopy influence summer surface temperatures across neighbourhoods in Leicester. The key point is that the study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.

Funder or partner

Draft language for funder or partner audiences, written in a clear and calm tone and requiring expert review.

Funder or partner

Urban heat and neighbourhood design offers the public value, progress and next-stage opportunity, using verified project information to help people understand what the work can—and cannot—say.

This work demonstrates an evidence-led approach to urban heat and neighbourhood design. This project examines how land cover, building density and tree canopy influence summer surface temperatures across neighbourhoods in Leicester. The key point is that the study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.

Customer or client

Draft language for customer or client audiences, written in a clear and calm tone and requiring expert review.

Customer or client

Urban heat and neighbourhood design offers the practical problem the work can help clarify, using verified project information to help people understand what the work can—and cannot—say.

This work shows how better evidence can support urban heat and neighbourhood design. This project examines how land cover, building density and tree canopy influence summer surface temperatures across neighbourhoods in Leicester. The key point is that the study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.

Journalist or media contact

Draft language for journalist or media contact audiences, written in a clear and calm tone and requiring expert review.

Journalist or media contact

Urban heat and neighbourhood design offers the timely finding, context and what it does not establish, using verified project information to help people understand what the work can—and cannot—say.

Researchers are examining urban heat and neighbourhood design. This project examines how land cover, building density and tree canopy influence summer surface temperatures across neighbourhoods in Leicester. The key point is that the study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.

Technical peer

Draft language for technical peer audiences, written in a clear and calm tone and requiring expert review.

Urban heat and neighbourhood design offers the method, scope, assumptions and contribution, using verified project information to help people understand what the work can—and cannot—say.

This work investigates urban heat and neighbourhood design. This project examines how land cover, building density and tree canopy influence summer surface temperatures across neighbourhoods in Leicester. The key point is that the study uses satellite-derived land surface temperature data.

Science-to-Story Translator: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Project, study or initiative name

For example: Urban heat and neighbourhood design

Technical source text or abstract

Use only text that has already been checked by the relevant researcher, team or source owner.

Intended audience

- ☐ Public ☐ Policy or public sector ☐ Funder or partner ☐ Customer or client ☐ Journalist or media contact
☐ Technical peer

Communication objective

- ☐ Build awareness ☐ Encourage sign-up ☐ Encourage download ☐ Drive event registration
☐ Start a partnership conversation

Tone

- ☐ Clear and calm ☐ Practical and direct ☐ Curious and inviting ☐ Formal and concise
☐ Purposeful, not alarmist

Reading level

- ☐ General public ☐ Interested non-specialist ☐ Professional audience ☐ Technical specialist

Required facts or claims to retain

These are treated as protected facts in the generated drafts. Verify wording before use.

Required caveats and limitations

Add one caveat or limitation per line.

Required links or sources

Add one link or source label per line.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

SEO Brief-to-Page Lab: reference

MARKETING & COMMUNICATIONS PROTOTYPE

Build a practical brief for an article, service, tool, event, course, campaign or portfolio page. Start with audience need and page purpose; then use search, structure, linking, metadata and structured data to make that useful page easier to discover.

SEO is useful information design. The aim is not to force keywords into a page. It is to help the right audience find clear, accurate, credible information and take an appropriate next step.

Page plan

A service page plan for Science communication consultancy.

Search and user need

PRIMARY QUERY

READER TASK

RELATED QUESTIONS

- What does a science communication consultant do?
- How do you make technical research understandable?
- When should a research team bring in communications support?

Recommended page structure

- Clear answer above the fold: State who the service is for, the problem it helps solve and the practical outcome.
- Relevant problems and situations: Show the contexts in which this service is useful so visitors can recognise their own need.
- What support includes: Explain deliverables, boundaries and ways of working in clear reader language.
- Evidence and experience: Use selected examples, expertise, outcomes and collaborators where permission allows.
- How engagement works: Explain scope, stages, timing and the first conversation without hiding important constraints.
- Questions and next step: Address fit, budget range, availability or process questions before presenting one focused CTA.

Internal-link opportunities

- Evidence: Link to a relevant case study or example showing experience with Science communication consultancy.
- Depth: Link to an explainer, article or resource that demonstrates subject knowledge.
- Decision: Link to process, booking, contact or related service information.

Search-result preview

example.com/service/science-communication-consultancy

Science communication consultancy | Specialist Support

Practical support for Science communication consultancy for Research organisations and science-led teams. Understand the key considerations and decide whether specialist communication support is relevant, understand the available help,

and choose a sensible next step.

Title: 54 characters. Description: 268 characters. Length is guidance only; clarity and accuracy are more important.

Schema recommendation

Organization

ProfessionalService

Service

FAQPage

Structured data should describe content visible to readers. Validate Google-eligible markup with the Rich Results Test, and use the Schema Markup Validator for broader Schema.org validation.

CTA and conversion path

Primary CTA: Discuss your project

Page → relevant evidence → concise contact form → acknowledgement with a clear response expectation.

Editorial checks before publication

- The page names a specific audience and a real task.
- The primary query describes the page naturally and accurately.
- The page addresses meaningful related questions rather than thin keyword variations.
- ! Check the title and meta description represent the page honestly without overpromising.
- ! Check headings, image alternatives, mobile layout, page performance and form labels.
- ! State what is included, what is not included, and who the service may not suit.
- ! Use real, approved evidence of experience rather than generic expertise claims.
- ! Make the contact or booking process and expected response time clear.

Guidance by Search intent

Commercial investigation

Commercial investigation

Informational

Transactional

Navigational

SEO Brief-to-Page Lab: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Page type

- ☐ Service page
 ☐ Article or guide
 ☐ Resource or download
 ☐ Case study
 ☐ Campaign landing page
 ☐ Product or paid digital offer
 ☐ Event or webinar page
 ☐ Course or workshop page
 ☐ Portfolio project page
 ☐ About or expertise page
 ☐ Location or local-service page
 ☐ Comparison or alternatives page
 ☐ FAQ or help-centre page
 ☐ Data story or research explainer
 ☐ Interactive tool page

Topic, offer or project

Describe the page subject as specifically as possible.

Search intent

- ☐ Commercial investigation
 ☐ Informational
 ☐ Transactional
 ☐ Navigational

Primary conversion

- ☐ Send an enquiry
 ☐ Book a call
 ☐ Download a resource
 ☐ Join the newsletter
 ☐ Use a related tool

Primary query

Use the clearest phrase a person could use to find this page, rather than a long list of variations.

Primary audience

Who is the page primarily for?

User task

What should a visitor understand, decide or do after reading?

Related questions to answer

Include questions that would help a real visitor complete the task, not thin keyword variations.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Theory of Change Mapper: reference

VISUAL PROGRAMME-DESIGN PROTOTYPE

Build a connected pathway from inputs and activities to outputs, near-term outcomes, longer-term outcomes and intended impact. Use assumptions, risks and evidence signals to turn an ambitious funding narrative into a more testable, evaluable programme design.

A theory of change is a hypothesis, not a guarantee. It should state what needs to be true, who needs to be involved, what could disrupt the pathway and how progress will be observed and adapted over time.

Connected pathway

A visual hypothesis of how programme activity could contribute to intended outcomes and impact.

Inputs

Activities

Outputs

Outcomes

Impact

Contribution pathway

Assumption or dependency

INPUTS ACTIVITIES OUTPUTS OUTCOMES IMPACT INPUT Research funding, EO data and local partnerships
Funding, satellite-derived heat indicators, geographic data, research expertise and ASSUMPTION NOTED ACTIVITY
Neighbourhood climate evidence workshops Bring satellite-derived heat evidence together with local knowledge, lived experience and ASSUMPTION NOTED OUTPUT Shared heat-risk maps and action briefs Produce accessible maps, plain-language explainers and locally relevant decision ASSUMPTION NOTED OUTCOME Improved local decision capability Partners have a stronger evidence base and shared language for considering heat, ASSUMPTION NOTED IMPACT More equitable heat-resilience planning The programme contributes to better-informed and more inclusive approaches to reducing ASSUMPTION NOTED Cooler neighbourhoods: evidence, engagement and green infrastructure

PATHWAY COMPLETENESS

All five stages are represented. Check whether each connection is plausible, specific and proportionate to the proposed scale.

EVIDENCE PLANNING

5 of 5 nodes have an evidence indicator. Add measures for both delivery and meaningful changes, not only outputs or reach.

ASSUMPTION CHECK

5 of 5 nodes include an explicit assumption. Review power, feasibility, context and dependencies at each link.

Funding-bid reviewer prompts

- ? What specific problem or opportunity is the programme trying to change, and for whom?
- ? Does every output have a credible route to an outcome, rather than assuming that delivery alone creates change?
- ? Which stakeholders are involved in interpreting needs, designing activities and judging whether change is meaningful?

- ? What assumptions, external conditions, risks or power dynamics could disrupt the pathway?
- ? How will you monitor delivery, learn during implementation and adapt if expected outcomes do not emerge?
- ? Which changes are realistically measurable during the funding period, and which are longer-term intended contributions?

Guidance by Pathway stage

Input

Activity

Output

Outcome

Impact

Theory of Change Mapper: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Programme or bid title

For example: Healthier places through local climate evidence

Pathway stage

☐ Input ☐ Activity ☐ Output ☐ Outcome ☐ Impact

Indicative timeframe

☐ 0–6 months ☐ 6–12 months ☐ 1–2 years ☐ 2–5 years ☐ 5+ years

Node title

For example: Co-designed evidence workshops

What happens or changes?

Be specific about the resource, action, deliverable, change or longer-term benefit.

Evidence or indicator

How would you know this happened or changed?

Critical assumption or dependency

What must be true for this step to lead to the next?

Connect from

Link this node to a preceding node. The connector represents a hypothesis, not proof of causation.

☐ Start a new pathway ☐ Input: Research funding, EO data and local partnerships
☐ Activity: Neighbourhood climate evidence workshops ☐ Output: Shared heat-risk maps and action briefs
☐ Outcome: Improved local decision capability ☐ Impact: More equitable heat-resilience planning

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Impact Pathway Canvas: reference

INTERACTIVE IMPACT-PLANNING PROTOTYPE

Build an impact pathway by linking a research finding to the people who matter, the engagement activity that could enable use, the change you intend to contribute to, and the evidence needed to make a responsible claim later.

A pathway is a hypothesis, not proof of impact. It helps a team test whether the finding is relevant, whether people can use it, what engagement is appropriate, and what evidence should be captured as activity unfolds.

Impact pathway

Drag cards to organise the map. Click a card to inspect its contribution, owner and evidence or assumption.

Finding

Stakeholder

Activity

Outcome

Evidence

Contribution pathway

Assumption view

PATHWAY COVERAGE

All five stages are represented. Check whether the links explain a credible route rather than a linear promise.

EVIDENCE READINESS

1 evidence card added. Ensure each records a specific source, timing and what it can—and cannot—support.

ENGAGEMENT PROMPT

2 stakeholder cards and 2 activity cards added. Clarify which activities are genuinely two-way and how participants can influence the work.

Impact-plan review prompts

- ? Which specific research finding underpins this pathway, and what are its limits or uncertainties?
- ? Who benefits, who decides, who may be affected, and how are those groups able to shape interpretation or action?
- ? Does the engagement activity involve listening, exchange, co-design or accountability—not only one-way dissemination?
- ? What needs to happen between the activity and the intended outcome, and what external conditions could disrupt that route?
- ? What evidence will show use, change, reach and significance rather than merely outputs, attendance or media coverage?
- ? Which claims are planned, which are documented, and which have independent external corroboration?

Guidance by Pathway stage

Research finding

Stakeholder / beneficiary

Engagement activity

Outcome or intended change

Evidence of impact

Impact Pathway Canvas: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Research project or programme

For example: Satellite evidence for healthier local places

Pathway stage

- ☐ Research finding ☐ Stakeholder / beneficiary ☐ Engagement activity ☐ Outcome or intended change
- ☐ Evidence of impact

Status

- ☐ Planned ☐ Active ☐ Documented ☐ Externally validated

Card title

For example: Local authority planning teams

What does this contribute?

Describe the research, user, activity, outcome or evidence source in specific terms.

Owner or partner

For example: Principal investigator and local authority climate team

Assumption, risk or dependency

What has to be true for this part of the pathway to work?

Connect from

Connections describe a plausible contribution pathway. They do not establish causation or prove later impact.

- ☐ Start a new pathway ☐ Research finding: Urban heat pattern
- ☐ Stakeholder / beneficiary: Neighbourhood organisations ☐ Engagement activity: Evidence workshops
- ☐ Stakeholder / beneficiary: Local authority planning teams ☐ Engagement activity: Decision-ready map and briefing
- ☐ Outcome / intended change: Better local prioritisation ☐ Evidence of impact: Traceable evidence of use and change

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Evidence Strength Ladder: reference

RESEARCH COMMUNICATION AND IMPACT PROTOTYPE

Place a research claim on a practical evidence ladder. See what can responsibly be said now, what still cannot be claimed, what evidence would strengthen the case, and how to write about it without turning activity or reach into proof of societal impact.

Evidence of activity is not automatically evidence of impact. A publication, dataset, media mention, event, download or positive comment may matter, but it does not alone demonstrate that research changed policy, practice, behaviour or wider outcomes.

Evidence position

Selected stage: Pattern or association. The evidence checklist currently supports Stage 2 as the conservative default.

Pattern or association

Responsible current claim

Urban heat and neighbourhood design: Analysis of Leicester neighbourhoods suggests that lower tree canopy and more impervious surfaces are associated with higher daytime land surface temperatures.

WHAT CAN RESPONSIBLY BE SAID

You can describe an observed trend, comparison or association, using appropriately qualified language such as “is associated with”, “suggests” or “was observed alongside”.

WHAT CANNOT YET BE CLAIMED

Do not present association as proof of causation, claim that the finding has changed a decision, or imply that a societal benefit has already occurred.

EVIDENCE NEEDED TO PROGRESS

Develop and test a credible pathway from the finding to potential use; examine alternative explanations, uncertainty, context and stakeholder relevance.

EXAMPLE WORDING

Reviewer questions

- ! Does the wording distinguish association, correlation or pattern from causation?
- ! What alternative explanations, confounders or data limitations need to be acknowledged?
- ! Who needs to interpret the finding alongside local, professional or lived experience?
- ! What decision or question could the finding inform, without overclaiming its authority?

Next evidence steps

- Evidence present — Stage 1: Retain an approved, traceable research output, data source, method or observation record.
- Evidence present — Stage 2: Document the analysis, trend, comparison or association and its scope.
- ! Evidence gap — Stage 3: Set out and test a credible pathway explaining how the research could contribute to use or change.

- ! Evidence gap — Stage 4: Collect dated records showing who used the research, how and for what purpose.
- ! Evidence gap — Stage 5: Collect evidence of what changed in understanding, capacity, practice, policy, behaviour or service.
- ! Evidence gap — Stage 6: Secure independent external evidence that corroborates the specific benefit or impact claim.

Interpretation safeguard

Known limitations supplied for this claim: The analysis measures land surface temperature, not indoor temperature or individual heat exposure. The findings are associative and do not establish direct causation. Further local validation and community input are needed before prioritising interventions. Keep the claim at the pattern or association level unless the evidence trail justifies a stronger statement.

Guidance by Primary use

Funding proposal or impact plan

The analysis suggests a pattern that may inform further investigation and engagement with relevant stakeholders.

Research report or evaluation

Within the study scope, [finding] was associated with [related factor]. This does not by itself establish causation.

Public-facing webpage

The research suggests a relationship between [topic] and [factor], helping identify questions for further local investigation.

Impact case study

The work identified an evidence-based pattern that created a basis for discussion, validation and possible application.

Policy or partner briefing

The analysis identifies an association that may be relevant to [decision area], subject to contextual interpretation and further validation.

Evidence Strength Ladder: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Project, research or initiative

For example: Urban heat and neighbourhood design

Claim you want to make

Avoid adding causal language unless you have appropriate evidence for causation.

Primary use

- ☐ Funding proposal or impact plan ☐ Research report or evaluation ☐ Public-facing webpage ☐ Impact case study
☐ Policy or partner briefing

data-evidence

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

pattern-evidence

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

contribution-evidence

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

use-evidence

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

change-evidence

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

corroboration-evidence

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

Evidence notes or sources

Add outputs, partner feedback, records, references, metrics or sources you have.

Known caveats or limits

Add assumptions, uncertainty, scope limitations or alternative explanations.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.

Stakeholder Constellation: reference

VISUAL STAKEHOLDER-MAPPING PROTOTYPE

Place a research finding at the centre of a visual constellation. Map stakeholder groups by influence, expected benefit, involvement, relationship strength, engagement need and exclusion risk—then identify where to listen, collaborate or build trust first.

Use this as a planning prompt, not a complete stakeholder analysis. Scores are subjective and should be discussed with relevant partners and communities. Do not use the tool to justify excluding groups from decisions that affect them.

Constellation view

Click any node to inspect it. Lines show the collaboration status; larger nodes indicate greater overall relevance.

Node size: relevance

Active collaboration

Consultation / proposed

Co-production

Closer node: stronger relationship

Closer to centre = stronger existing relationship
 Research finding Urban heat research: lower tree canopy and more impervious surfaces are associated with...
 1 Local authority planners R 4.4 · Rel 3/5
 2 Neighbourhood organisations R 4.4 · Rel 2/5
 3 Public-health teams R 4.0 · Rel 3/5
 4 Funders R 2.6 · Rel 4/5
 5 Parks and green-space teams R 3.8 · Rel 3/5

HIGHEST PRIORITY

Neighbourhood organisations has the highest combined priority score. Start by confirming the right engagement route and what meaningful involvement looks like.

RELATIONSHIP GAP

Neighbourhood organisations has a high need for engagement but a relatively weak existing relationship. Prioritise trust-building before asking for input.

INCLUSION PROMPT

Neighbourhood organisations has a high exclusion-risk score. Check barriers to participation, representation, power and whether engagement can influence decisions.

Suggested engagement priorities

- 1 Neighbourhood organisations — high exclusion risk, strong need for engagement, likely direct benefit, relationship needs development. Current status: consultation needed.
- 2 Local authority planners — high exclusion risk, strong need for engagement, significant decision influence, likely direct benefit. Current status: active collaboration.
- 3 Public-health teams — high exclusion risk, strong need for engagement, significant decision influence, likely direct benefit. Current status: active collaboration.
- 4 Parks and green-space teams — strong need for engagement, significant decision influence, likely direct benefit. Current status: consultation needed.
- 5 Funders — significant decision influence. Current status: active collaboration.

Guidance by Collaboration status

Proposed relationship

Consultation needed

Active collaboration

Co-production / shared decision-making

Stakeholder Constellation: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Research finding at the centre

Keep this factual and appropriately qualified. It becomes the centre node.

Stakeholder group

For example: Neighbourhood organisations

Why this group matters

Describe their likely role, perspective, decision, benefit or concern.

Influence over a decision

1 5

Likely benefit from the research

1 5

Degree of involvement

1 5

Existing relationship strength

1 5

Need for engagement or consultation

1 5

Potential risk if excluded

1 5

Collaboration status

☐ Proposed relationship ☐ Consultation needed ☐ Active collaboration ☐ Co-production / shared decision-making

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.